



Receive and place incoming telephone calls

D1.HFO.CL2.09

Trainer Guide



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Trainer Guide



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& hospitality

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Competency Based Training (CBT) and assessment – An introduction for trainers

Competency

Competency refers to the ability to perform particular tasks and duties to the standard of performance expected in the workplace.

Competency requires the application of specified knowledge, skills and attitudes relevant to effective participation, consistently over time and in the workplace environment.

The essential skills and knowledge are either identified separately or combined.

Knowledge identifies what a person needs to know to perform the work in an informed and effective manner.

Skills describe the application of knowledge to situations where understanding is converted into a workplace outcome.

Attitude describes the founding reasons behind the need for certain knowledge or why skills are performed in a specified manner.

Competency covers all aspects of workplace performance and involves:

- Performing individual tasks
- Managing a range of different tasks
- Responding to contingencies or breakdowns
- Dealing with the responsibilities of the workplace
- Working with others.

Unit of Competency

Like with any training qualification or program, a range of subject topics are identified that focus on the ability in a certain work area, responsibility or function.

Each manual focuses on a specific unit of competency that applies in the hospitality workplace.

In this manual a unit of competency is identified as a 'unit'.

Each unit of competency identifies a discrete workplace requirement and includes:

- Knowledge and skills that underpin competency
- Language, literacy and numeracy
- Occupational safety and health requirements.

Each unit of competency must be adhered to in training and assessment to ensure consistency of outcomes.

Element of Competency

An element of competency describes the essential outcomes within a unit of competency.

The elements of competency are the basic building blocks of the unit of competency. They describe in terms of outcomes the significant functions and tasks that make up the competency.

In this manual elements of competency are identified as an 'element'.

Performance criteria

Performance criteria indicate the standard of performance that is required to demonstrate achievement within an element of competency. The standards reflect identified industry skill needs.

Performance criteria will be made up of certain specified skills, knowledge and attitudes.

Learning

For the purpose of this manual learning incorporates two key activities:

- Training
- Assessment.

Both of these activities will be discussed in detail in this introduction.

Today training and assessment can be delivered in a variety of ways. It may be provided to participants:

- On-the-job – in the workplace
- Off-the-job – at an educational institution or dedicated training environment
- As a combination of these two options.

No longer is it necessary for learners to be absent from the workplace for long periods of time in order to obtain recognised and accredited qualifications.

Learning Approaches

This manual will identify two avenues to facilitate learning:

Competency Based Training (CBT)

This is the strategy of developing a participant's competency.

Educational institutions utilise a range of training strategies to ensure that participants are able to gain the knowledge and skills required for successful:

- Completion of the training program or qualification
- Implementation in the workplace.

The strategies selected should be chosen based on suitability and the learning styles of participants.

Competency Based Assessment (CBA)

This is the strategy of assessing competency of a participant.

Educational institutions utilise a range of assessment strategies to ensure that participants are assessed in a manner that demonstrates validity, fairness, reliability, flexibility and fairness of assessment processes.

Flexibility in Learning

It is important to note that flexibility in training and assessment strategies is required to meet the needs of participants who may have learning difficulties. The strategies used will vary, taking into account the needs of individual participants with learning difficulties. However they will be applied in a manner which does not discriminate against the participant or the participant body as a whole.

Catering for Participant Diversity

Participants have diverse backgrounds, needs and interests. When planning training and assessment activities to cater for individual differences, trainers and assessors should:

- Consider individuals' experiences, learning styles and interests
- Develop questions and activities that are aimed at different levels of ability
- Modify the expectations for some participants
- Provide opportunities for a variety of forms of participation, such as individual, pair and small group activities
- Assess participants based on individual progress and outcomes.

The diversity among participants also provides a good reason for building up a learning community in which participants support each other's learning.

Participant Centred Learning

This involves taking into account structuring training and assessment that:

- *Builds on strengths* – Training environments need to demonstrate the many positive features of local participants (such as the attribution of academic success to effort, and the social nature of achievement motivation) and of their trainers (such as a strong emphasis on subject disciplines and moral responsibility). These strengths and uniqueness of local participants and trainers should be acknowledged and treasured
- *Acknowledges prior knowledge and experience* – The learning activities should be planned with participants' prior knowledge and experience in mind
- *Understands learning objectives* – Each learning activity should have clear learning objectives and participants should be informed of them at the outset. Trainers should also be clear about the purpose of assignments and explain their significance to participants
- *Teaches for understanding* – The pedagogies chosen should aim at enabling participants to act and think flexibly with what they know
- *Teaches for independent learning* – Generic skills and reflection should be nurtured through learning activities in appropriate contexts of the curriculum. Participants should be encouraged to take responsibility for their own learning

- *Enhances motivation* – Learning is most effective when participants are motivated. Various strategies should be used to arouse the interest of participants
- *Makes effective use of resources* – A variety of teaching resources can be employed as tools for learning
- *Maximises engagement* – In conducting learning activities, it is important for the minds of participants to be actively engaged
- *Aligns assessment with learning and teaching* – Feedback and assessment should be an integral part of learning and teaching
- *Caters for learner diversity* – Trainers should be aware that participants have different characteristics and strengths and try to nurture these rather than impose a standard set of expectations.

Active Learning

The goal of nurturing independent learning in participants does not imply that they always have to work in isolation or solely in a classroom. On the contrary, the construction of knowledge in tourism and hospitality studies can often best be carried out in collaboration with others in the field. Sharing experiences, insights and views on issues of common concern, and working together to collect information through conducting investigative studies in the field (active learning) can contribute a lot to their eventual success.

Active learning has an important part to play in fostering a sense of community in the class. First, to operate successfully, a learning community requires an ethos of acceptance and a sense of trust among participants, and between them and their trainers. Trainers can help to foster acceptance and trust through encouragement and personal example, and by allowing participants to take risks as they explore and articulate their views, however immature these may appear to be. Participants also come to realise that their classmates (and their trainers) are partners in learning and solving.

Trainers can also encourage cooperative learning by designing appropriate group learning tasks, which include, for example, collecting background information, conducting small-scale surveys, or producing media presentations on certain issues and themes. Participants need to be reminded that, while they should work towards successful completion of the field tasks, developing positive peer relationships in the process is an important objective of all group work.

Competency Based Training (CBT)

Principle of Competency Based Training

Competency based training is aimed at developing the knowledge, skills and attitudes of participants, through a variety of training tools.

Training Strategies

The aims of this curriculum are to enable participants to:

- Undertake a variety of subject courses that are relevant to industry in the current environment
- Learn current industry skills, information and trends relevant to industry
- Learn through a range of practical and theoretical approaches
- Be able to identify, explore and solve issues in a productive manner

- Be able to become confident, equipped and flexible managers of the future
- Be 'job ready' and a valuable employee in the industry upon graduation of any qualification level.

To ensure participants are able to gain the knowledge and skills required to meet competency in each unit of competency in the qualification, a range of training delivery modes are used.

Types of Training

In choosing learning and teaching strategies, trainers should take into account the practical, complex and multi-disciplinary nature of the subject area, as well as their participant's prior knowledge, learning styles and abilities.

Training outcomes can be attained by utilising one or more delivery methods:

Lecture/Tutorial

This is a common method of training involving transfer of information from the trainer to the participants. It is an effective approach to introduce new concepts or information to the learners and also to build upon the existing knowledge. The listener is expected to reflect on the subject and seek clarifications on the doubts.

Demonstration

Demonstration is a very effective training method that involves a trainer showing a participant how to perform a task or activity. Through a visual demonstration, trainers may also explain reasoning behind certain actions or provide supplementary information to help facilitate understanding.

Group Discussions

Brainstorming in which all the members in a group express their ideas, views and opinions on a given topic. It is a free flow and exchange of knowledge among the participants and the trainer. The discussion is carried out by the group on the basis of their own experience, perceptions and values. This will facilitate acquiring new knowledge. When everybody is expected to participate in the group discussion, even the introverted persons will also get stimulated and try to articulate their feelings.

The ideas that emerge in the discussions should be noted down and presentations are to be made by the groups. Sometimes consensus needs to be arrived at on a given topic. Group discussions are to be held under the moderation of a leader guided by the trainer. Group discussion technique triggers thinking process, encourages interactions and enhances communication skills.

Role Play

This is a common and very effective method of bringing into the classroom real life situations, which may not otherwise be possible. Participants are made to enact a particular role so as to give a real feel of the roles they may be called upon to play. This enables participants to understand the behaviour of others as well as their own emotions and feelings. The instructor must brief the role players on what is expected of them. The role player may either be given a ready-made script, which they can memorize and enact, or they may be required to develop their own scripts around a given situation. This technique is extremely useful in understanding creative selling techniques and human relations. It can be entertaining and energizing and it helps the reserved and less literate to express their feelings.

Simulation Games

When trainees need to become aware of something that they have not been conscious of, simulations can be a useful mechanism. Simulation games are a method based on "here and now" experience shared by all the participants. The games focus on the participation of the trainees and their willingness to share their ideas with others. A "near real life" situation is created providing an opportunity to which they apply themselves by adopting certain behaviour. They then experience the impact of their behaviour on the situation. It is carried out to generate responses and reactions based on the real feelings of the participants, which are subsequently analysed by the trainer.

While use of simulation games can result in very effective learning, it needs considerable trainer competence to analyse the situations.

Individual /Group Exercises

Exercises are often introduced to find out how much the participant has assimilated. This method involves imparting instructions to participants on a particular subject through use of written exercises. In the group exercises, the entire class is divided into small groups, and members are asked to collaborate to arrive at a consensus or solution to a problem.

Case Study

This is a training method that enables the trainer and the participant to experience a real life situation. It may be on account of events in the past or situations in the present, in which there may be one or more problems to be solved and decisions to be taken. The basic objective of a case study is to help participants diagnose, analyse and/or solve a particular problem and to make them internalize the critical inputs delivered in the training. Questions are generally given at the end of the case study to direct the participants and to stimulate their thinking towards possible solutions. Studies may be presented in written or verbal form.

Field Visit

This involves a carefully planned visit or tour to a place of learning or interest. The idea is to give first-hand knowledge by personal observation of field situations, and to relate theory with practice. The emphasis is on observing, exploring, asking questions and understanding. The trainer should remember to brief the participants about what they should observe and about the customs and norms that need to be respected.

Group Presentation

The participants are asked to work in groups and produce the results and findings of their group work to the members of another sub-group. By this method participants get a good picture of each other's views and perceptions on the topic and they are able to compare them with their own point of view. The pooling and sharing of findings enriches the discussion and learning process.

Practice Sessions

This method is of paramount importance for skills training. Participants are provided with an opportunity to practice in a controlled situation what they have learnt. It could be real life or through a make-believe situation.

Games

This is a group process and includes those methods that involve usually fun-based activity, aimed at conveying feelings and experiences, which are everyday in nature, and applying them within the game being played. A game has set rules and regulations, and may or may not include a competitive element. After the game is played, it is essential that the participants be debriefed and their lessons and experiences consolidated by the trainer.

Research

Trainers may require learners to undertake research activities, including online research, to gather information or further understanding about a specific subject area.

Competency Based Assessment (CBA)

Principle of Competency Based Assessment

Competency based assessment is aimed at compiling a list of evidence that shows that a person is competent in a particular unit of competency.

Competencies are gained through a multitude of ways including:

- Training and development programs
- Formal education
- Life experience
- Apprenticeships
- On-the-job experience
- Self-help programs.

All of these together contribute to job competence in a person. Ultimately, assessors and participants work together, through the 'collection of evidence' in determining overall competence.

This evidence can be collected:

- Using different formats
- Using different people
- Collected over a period of time.

The assessor who is ideally someone with considerable experience in the area being assessed, reviews the evidence and verifies the person as being competent or not.

Flexibility in Assessment

Whilst allocated assessment tools have been identified for this subject, all attempts are made to determine competency and suitable alternate assessment tools may be used, according to the requirements of the participant.

The assessment needs to be equitable for all participants, taking into account their cultural and linguistic needs.

Competency must be proven regardless of:

- Language
- Delivery Method
- Assessment Method.

Assessment Objectives

The assessment tools used for subjects are designed to determine competency against the 'elements of competency' and their associated 'performance criteria'.

The assessment tools are used to identify sufficient:

- a) Knowledge, including underpinning knowledge
- b) Skills
- c) Attitudes

Assessment tools are activities that trainees are required to undertake to prove participant competency in this subject.

All assessments must be completed satisfactorily for participants to obtain competence in this subject. There are no exceptions to this requirement, however, it is possible that in some cases several assessment items may be combined and assessed together.

Types of Assessment

Allocated Assessment Tools

There are a number of assessment tools that are used to determine competency in this subject:

- Work projects
- Written questions
- Oral questions
- Third Party Report
- Observation Checklist.

Instructions on how assessors should conduct these assessment methods are explained in the Assessment Manuals.

Alternative Assessment Tools

Whilst this subject has identified assessment tools, as indicated above, this does not restrict the assessor from using different assessment methods to measure the competency of a participant.

Evidence is simply proof that the assessor gathers to show participants can actually do what they are required to do.

Whilst there is a distinct requirement for participants to demonstrate competency, there are many and diverse sources of evidence available to the assessor.

Ongoing performance at work, as verified by a supervisor or physical evidence, can count towards assessment. Additionally, the assessor can talk to customers or work colleagues to gather evidence about performance.

A range of assessment methods to assess competency include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals: slides, audio tapes
- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects
- Role plays
- Group projects
- Group discussions
- Examinations.

Recognition of Prior Learning

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

Also known as a Skills Recognition Audit (SRA), this process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Assessing competency

As mentioned, assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency. Traditionally in education, grades or marks were given to participants, dependent on how many questions the participant successfully answered in an assessment tool.

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- Pass Competent (PC)
- Not Yet Competent (NYC)
- Pass Competent (PC).

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: RECEIVE AND PLACE INCOMING TELEPHONE CALLS		NOMINAL HOURS: 15
UNIT NUMBER: D1.HFO.CL2.09		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to receive incoming calls and to deal effectively with them by transferring and/or re-directing them, as appropriate, or by taking other suitable action within the travel industries workplace context.		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1: Identify elements and facilities of the host enterprise telephone system 1.1 Identify the <i>types of incoming calls</i> that may be received and their importance to the business 1.2 Identify the <i>components of the telephone system</i> 1.3 Describe the <i>functions and features available in the telephone system</i> Element 2: Demonstrate appropriate telephone communication skills 2.1 Interpret the <i>enterprise policies and procedures for telephone use</i> in regard to incoming calls 2.2 Explain the importance of first impressions in relation to telephone answering and the reputation of the business 2.3 Differentiate between face-to-face and over-the-phone communications 2.4 Use appropriate <i>telephone communication skills</i>		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment This unit applies to all industry sectors that receive and place incoming telephone calls within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Front Office Types of incoming calls may be related to: • Enquire • Enquiries • Reservations • Complaints • Messages for management, staff and guests • Clarification of orders from suppliers • Return calls

2.5 Use appropriate <i>telephone techniques</i> 2.6 Describe acceptable <i>telephone etiquette</i> 2.7 Identify <i>common caller complaints</i> about telephoning a business Element 3: Receive incoming calls 3.1 <i>Prepare to receive</i> incoming calls 3.2 <i>Answer calls</i> promptly in accordance with house standards 3.3 Identify long-distance or international calls 3.4 <i>Establish purpose</i> of incoming calls 3.5 <i>Respond to caller requests</i>, where appropriate 3.6 <i>Take messages</i> from callers 3.7 <i>Relay messages</i> and follow-up as necessary 3.8 Facilitate conference calls 3.9 Deal with <i>suspicious or threatening calls</i> 3.10 Manage <i>difficult callers</i> 3.11 <i>Prepare voicemail messages</i> and background music Element 4: Re-direct incoming calls 4.1 <i>Transfer calls</i> as appropriate 4.2 <i>Place calls on hold</i> as appropriate	Components of the telephone system may include: • Landline telephones, including multiple lines and multiple telephone numbers • Mobile/cell phones • Paging systems • Switchboards • Handsets and headsets • Caller identification facilities, including VIP caller ID. Functions and features available in the telephone system may be related to: • Call waiting • Call forwarding • Caller ID display • Line blocking • Call back busy • No answer, and busy-no answer • Call return • Recorded message service • Executive busy override • Transfer and transfer recall • Placing calls on hold • Multiple chat facility • Conference call • Integration of facilities.
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	Enterprise policies and procedures for telephone use may include: • Privacy and confidentiality issues • Response to threatening or suspicious calls • Standard greetings • Authorisation(s) to use the system and nominated elements of it • Training requirements • Stated priorities for in-person customers in relation to telephone callers. Telephone communication skills should relate to: • Conveying a helpful and positive attitude • Using the voice effectively and appropriately given the nature of the incoming call • Applying effective listening and questioning skills • Demonstrating positive speaking skills, including clarity and the need to be concise • Responding professionally to all manner of incoming calls • Choosing appropriate tone, volume and language to use in response to each incoming call • Screening calls, as required. Telephone techniques may include: • Clarifying caller requirements • Repeating back names, dates and times • Using the phonetic alphabet when clarifying caller details • Realising the caller cannot read your facial expressions and understand other pressures that might be applicable at the time of their call. Telephone etiquette must address: • Courtesy, civility and respect
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	• Reduction of background noise • Correct operation of system functions to prevent caller frustration • Using the caller's name when known • Thanking caller • Asking caller if they would like to hold before placing them on hold • Advising caller of your intentions in respect to dealing with their call • Advising caller of the name of the person to whom their call is being directed/transferred • Apologising for delays, including never leaving a caller on hold for longer than 30 seconds without some form of contact • Allowing caller to hang up before terminating the call. Common caller complaints may include: • Telephone rings too long before being answered • Being placed on hold for too long • Inability to get through, such as the line/number is always busy • Receptionist becomes defensive or abusive when asked for their name • Failure to determine where the call should be directed • Failure to listen • Incompetence with the system; for example, the caller is disconnected when being transferred • Lack of professionalism, including failure to place call on hold before talking to colleagues, giving an inappropriate greeting, lack of knowledge about the establishment and its staff • Improper tone of voice used by receptionist.
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	Prepare to receive calls may relate to: • Organising the work area • Obtaining or preparing internal telephone list, including for staff and guests • Obtaining list of internal extension numbers • Obtaining telephone system user manual/s • Eliminating distraction. <i>Answer calls</i> may relate to: • Answering before house ring limit is reached • Using host enterprise standard greeting • Identifying self and enterprise, greeting caller and making an offer of assistance • Focusing and concentrating on the call • Taking notes • Identifying whether caller is calling long-distance or internationally • Identifying if caller is a designated VIP caller • Screening calls • Placing existing calls on hold to answer incoming call. Establish purpose may include: • Clarifying caller need • Asking questions • Repeating information supplied by caller, including paraphrasing to confirm understanding • Seeking extra information.
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	Respond to caller requests may involve: • Answering caller queries • Seeking more information from caller • Apologising where an immediate, correct response cannot be given • Transferring call to the correct/more appropriate extension • Asking caller if they would like to hold or if they would prefer to be called back • Following-up. <i>Take messages</i> should include: • Offering voicemail alternative, if applicable • Identifying who message is for • Clarifying spelling of names • Obtaining and checking relevant dates, times and numbers • Repeating back all details • Noting action required and urgency of message. <i>Relay messages</i> may relate to: • Notifying person verbally • Lodging message in pigeon-hole or message book • Activating internal message waiting system • Using internal paging system • Returning to the caller to advise of progress of message.
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	Suspicious or threatening calls may relate to: • Capturing as much detail as possible about the call, caller and nature of the threat • Notifying management and other staff • Initiating an evacuation or implementation of the Emergency Management Plan (EMP) • Notifying relevant authorities • Assisting in calling department and room numbers to facilitate the warning of people in accordance with the Emergency Management Plan. Difficult callers may include: • Callers using a different language • Aggressive and abusive callers • Rude and impatient callers • Intoxicated callers. Prepare voicemail messages may relate to: • Determining the content of the message • Determining appropriate background music • Recording messages for callers who have been placed on hold • Recording messages for callers who are being transferred • Recording messages for individuals where there is no answer on the extension • Recording out of hour messages • Recording call waiting messages.
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	Transfer calls may include: • Determining name of caller and purpose of call • Thanking caller for the call • Advising caller of intention to transfer the call • Notifying to whom/where the call is to be transferred • Announcing call, if applicable. Place calls on hold may include: • Advising caller of intention to place them on hold • Asking caller if they would prefer to be called back instead of being placed on hold • Thanking caller and apologising for delay • Keeping in regular contact with all on hold calls and enquiring if they are still prepared to wait. Place calls on hold may include: • Advising caller of intention to place them on hold • Asking caller if they would prefer to be called back instead of being placed on hold • Thanking caller and apologising for delay • Keeping in regular contact with all on hold calls and enquiring if they are still prepared to wait.
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	Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • Knowledge of the enterprise's policies and procedures in regard to telephone operation and implementation of the Emergency Management Plan • Knowledge of the principles of telephone communication • Knowledge of the products, including knowledge about the host enterprise, staff, services offered, rates, contact details • Ability to use the host enterprise telephone systems and facilities • Ability to apply verbal communication, customer service, decision making, message taking and conflict resolution skills • Ability to cope under pressure. Linkages To Other Units • Communicate on the telephone • Facilitate out-going phone calls • Provide information about in-house services • Provide international (IDD) service information • Develop and update local knowledge • Maintain hospitality industry knowledge • Receive and resolve customer complaints • Work effectively with colleagues and customers • Work in a socially diverse environment • Promote products and services to customers • Operate a (PABX) switchboard.
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	Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Understanding of the functions and features of the host enterprise telephone system • Demonstrated ability to implement enterprise policies on telephone use • Demonstrated ability to answer calls and respond to a range of nominated enquiries • Demonstrated ability to transfer calls to nominated people/extensions • Demonstrated ability to place calls on hold • Demonstrated ability to record telephone voice messages • Demonstrated ability to take and effectively process telephone messages • Demonstrated ability to deal with a nominated range of suspicious, threatening and difficult telephone callers • Demonstrated ability to apply appropriate telephone techniques and etiquette. Context of Assessment This unit may be assessed on or off the job: • Assessment should include practical demonstration either in the workplace or through a simulation activity, supported by a range of methods to assess underpinning knowledge • Assessment must relate to the individual's work area or area of responsibility. Resource Implications Training and assessment to include access to a real or simulated workplace but must include the use of a real telephone system and real callers; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment.
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Assessment Methods

The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit:

- Case studies
- Observation of practical candidate performance
- Oral and written questions
- Portfolio evidence
- Problem solving
- Role plays
- Third party reports completed by a supervisor
- Project and assignment work.

Key Competencies in this Unit

Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively

Level 2 = competence to manage tasks

Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating

Key Competencies	Level	Examples
Collecting, organising and analysing information	1	Develop internal telephone, staff and contact lists; develop product and property knowledge
Communicating ideas and information	2	Speak with callers, determine needs and respond appropriately
Planning and organising activities	1	Prepare the area for work
Working with others and in teams	2	Liaise with others to meet stated caller needs

	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	-	
	Solving problems	1	Deal with telephone complaints
	Using technology	2	Operate the telephone system and its integrated elements

Notes and PowerPoint slides

Slide

RECEIVE AND PLACE INCOMING TELEPHONE CALLS



Slide 1

Slide No	Trainer Notes
1.	Discuss with trainees How does the way you would speak to a customer on the telephone differ to the way you would speak to your friends or family? How many of you have ever worked in a job where you need to speak to customers on the telephone? What hints can you share with the rest of the class?

Slide

1. Identify elements and facilities of the host enterprise telephone system



Slide 2

Slide No

Trainer Notes

2.

Class discussion

How many of you have a mobile phone? Make a list of the features available on a mobile phone e.g. camera, speaker phone, call forwarding etc. Which mobile phone features would also be available on a hotel phone system and how could they be used to improve the hotel's performance and customer service e.g. message recording. Is there a place for mobile phones in a hotel – how could they be used to improve efficiency?

Slide

Identify the types of incoming calls that may be received and their importance to the business

Types of incoming calls include:

- Enquiries
- Calls from people for guests
- Complaints
- Messages
- Contact with suppliers



Slide 3

Slide No	Trainer Notes
3.	• Since the 1890s telephones have enabled instant contact with hotels for bookings and requests • The telephone plays an important role in communication with a hotel and within a hotel or resort • Incoming calls by landline and contact via mobile or cell phone, including smart phones with internet linkage, make up a high percentage of guest contact with a hotel or resort • The primary role of a receptionist or telephonist in a hotel or resort is to answer all incoming calls • Incoming calls could be from external locations or in-house guests needing assistance or asking questions or staff contacting departments • What are the types of incoming calls? Class buzz session Looking at a hotel and its location list as many examples of incoming calls as the class can think of e.g. suppliers, contact for orders, new product, questions about orders that have been placed by the hotel etc. customer feedback etc. Complaints made may relate to service (too slow, not respectful), about rooms, bed comfort, bathroom cleanliness, access to pool, gym, activities etc.

Slide

Aspects of incoming calls

Incoming calls

Internal and
External
Customers



Handling complaints

Be:

- Helpful
- Positive
- Informed
- Tactful
- Polite



Slide 4

Slide No

Trainer Notes

4.

Role play

Trainees work in pairs to practice the roles of customers and reception staff making and receiving calls. If trainees are not confident to do this immediately they can spend some time writing up a dialogue that they can then perform with each other and then perhaps for the whole class group. When performing the role with each other trainees can sit back to back on chairs and pretend to be on the phone. Otherwise they can make real calls with their mobile phones and put it on speaker phone if the demonstration is being done for the whole class.

Trainees need to act their roles carefully – the Customer needs to complain strongly or at least be clear about what they want and the hotel reception staff member needs to display the qualities of helpfulness, being positive, informed, tactful and polite.

Aspects of incoming calls

Selling services and products



Provide information



Taking messages



Slide 5

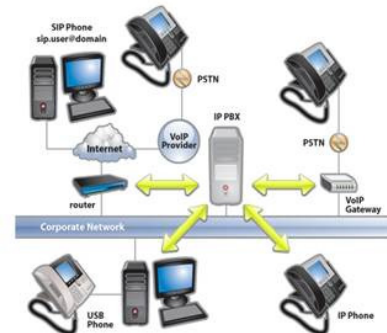
Slide No	Trainer Notes
5.	Role play Trainees work in pairs to practice the roles of customers and reception staff making and receiving calls. If trainees are not confident to do this immediately they can spend some time writing up a dialogue that they can then perform with each other and then perhaps for the whole class group. When performing the role with each other trainees can sit back to back on chairs and pretend to be on the phone. Otherwise they can make real calls with their mobile phones and put it on speaker phone if the demonstration is being done for the whole class. Trainees need to act their roles carefully – the Customer needs to complain strongly or at least be clear about what they want and the hotel reception staff member needs to display the qualities of helpfulness, being positive, informed, tactful and polite.

Slide

Identify the components of the telephone system

Components of a Telephone system:

- Landline versus Wireless
- Paging System
- Switchboard
- Handsets and head sets
- VoIP telephones



Slide 6

Slide No

Trainer Notes

6.

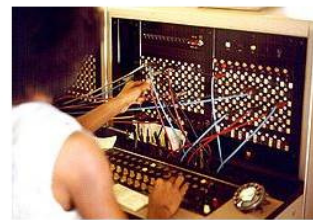
- A Landline telephone system is connected by solid wires or fibre optic cable, tangible and visible, from one location to another
- Mobile or cellular phones make and receive calls using radio link or wireless connection
- A paging system offers discrete and immediate communication for staff
- Paging systems and mobile phones allow staff to work in operational areas and still be able to respond quickly to requests
- A switchboard is a piece of equipment that enables a hotel or resort to connect all the telephone lines and extensions used
- The handset is the part of the telephone which the user holds to their ear. Handsets are often referred to as receivers
- Headsets fit over the head and enable hands free action which permits the operator to take notes or operate a computer while taking a telephone call
- VoIP telephones use the internet to link and are rapidly increasing in usage, overtaking the traditional telephone network. The VoIP system enables notification of calls via email or text.

Slide

Describe the functions and features available in the telephone system

Features and functions of the system may include:

- The facility to place calls on hold or transfer calls
 - To record messages
 - Text transmission
- (Continued)



Slide 7

Slide No	Trainer Notes
7.	The telephone system has a number of features and functions such as: • The facility to place calls on hold or transfer calls • To record messages electronically or use voicemail • Message or text transmission. How would these features be used in practice to improve communication?

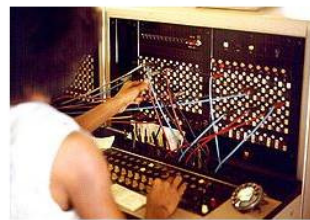
- The facility to place calls on hold or transfer calls
- To record messages electronically or use voicemail
- Message or text transmission.

How would these features be used in practice to improve communication?

Slide

Describe the functions and features available in the telephone system

- Notification of missed calls
- Call diversion
- Caller identification



Slide 8

Slide No	Trainer Notes
8.	The telephone system has a number of features and functions such as: • Notification of missed calls or busy numbers not answered • Call diversion and call blocking • Caller identification How would these features be used in practice to improve communication?

Class activity

- Work in groups and:
 - Compare the telephone needs of a small hotel against a large hotel
 - List the features and components of the system most suited to each
 - Compare the standard greetings of a small hotel against a large hotel.



Slide 9

Slide No	Trainer Notes
9.	• Switchboard • Multiple extensions • Multiple lines • Computer interface • Monitor all incoming and outgoing calls • Timed calls • Fax & Internet access (in-room) • Email access (in-room) • Single telephone line • Fax access (Venue use only. May be separate number to telephone) • Telephone • Email access.

Slide

2. Demonstrate appropriate telephone communication skills



Slide 10

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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10.	Explain to trainees that this section will discuss issues such as privacy concerns, dealing with threatening calls, security issues and appropriate telephone greetings.
-----	--

Slide

Interpret the enterprise policies and procedures for telephone use in regard to incoming calls

Policies and procedures for telephone use can relate to:

- Privacy
- Threatening calls
- Standard greetings
- Security and confidentiality
- Training



Slide 11

Slide No	Trainer Notes
11.	• The use of the telephone is one of the most vital business tools in use today • More business is won or lost on the phone than by any other means • Every staff member should undergo formal training in correct telephone procedures. Privacy A hotel or resort will have a policy to protect the privacy and confidentiality of its guests. Guests' messages and phone records are protected against fraudulent actions. Threatening calls Response to threatening or suspicious calls requires the receiver to remain calm, the call should be taken seriously and the receiver should not hang up. Greetings Standard greetings are established to maintain image or service quality. Staff should answer calls courteously and identify the time of day, and pronounce words clearly, slowly, and with adequate volume. Security Many hotels or resorts have created a "Privacy policy statement" relating to how and what they do with the personal information collected from guests. Staff can often be tempted to pass on information about celebrities or prominent people to newspapers and magazines when these guests are staying at their hotel.

	Training
--	------------------------

	Telephone system training is required to maintain the standards of the hotel or resort. All systems require upgrading and even replacing and this will mean upgrade training for the staff.
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Slide

Class activity

- Create a list of rules for handling celebrity phone calls
- Work in groups and discuss why privacy and confidentiality are protected
- Write up your results to compare them with other groups



Slide 12

Slide No	Trainer Notes
12.	Class discussion If any of the class has worked or is currently working in a hotel they should tell the rest of the class some of the different ways celebrities are treated compared to 'normal' guests. What things are most important to celebrities? for example, privacy, security. The class should work in small groups and, once they have composed their lists, share them with the rest of the class.

Slide

Explain the importance of first impressions in relation to telephone answering and the reputation of the business

The first impression you give is important:

- Your voice projects the establishment
- Tone and pitch must convey type and style of establishment
- Tone and language influence first impression and reflect on establishment reputation



Slide 13

Slide No	Trainer Notes
13.	The voice that answers the telephone projects the image of the establishment and the tone and pitch convey the type and style of establishment. Many establishments nominate a 'script' to follow so all staff who use the telephone system offer the same standard greeting and project the image of the establishment. The first impression a guest is given is lasting, and will be difficult to alter if it's an unfavourable one. The tone and language of the greeting will also influence the all important first impression and reflect on the establishments' reputation. In pairs trainees should write what they think would be a good standard greeting for a 4 or 5 star hotel. Try reading it out loud using appropriate tone and pitch.

Slide

Explain the importance of first impressions in relation to telephone answering and the reputation of the business

Class activity

- Write a standard greeting and present it to your class
- Is it giving a good first impression?
- Does it reflect an image?



Slide 14

Slide No	Trainer Notes
14.	In pairs trainees should write what they think would be a good standard greeting for a 4 or 5 star hotel. Try reading it out loud using appropriate tone and pitch.

Slide

Differentiate between face-to-face and over-the-phone communications

Face to face	Telephone
Body language	Impact of voice
Visual actions matching non-verbal	Pitch and tone
Visual aides used	Volume
Written communication	Questioning
	Listening



Slide 15

Slide No Trainer Notes

15. Over the phone staff need to communicate the major part of any information with voice only. Therefore how and what is said is suddenly that much more important.
- There is a need to think about voice tone, pace and volume, to project a professional image.
- On top of that things that would normally be shown visually, like friendliness or enthusiasm, also need to be communicated through the voice.
- During face to face conversation, people can not only hear responses from others, but also see their expressions and body language and interpret how they are feeling. Non-verbal responses can indicate that staff need to supply more information to clarify issues.
- Class activity**
- Students should listen to each other repeating the standard greeting and comment on the sound of the voice.

Slide

Use the appropriate telephone communication skills

All calls should be responded to:

- In a professional manner
- Answered promptly
- Answered politely

(Continued)



Slide 16

Slide No	Trainer Notes
16.	• Telephone communication requires certain skills including the appropriate attitude, energy level, voice tone and volume • The ability to speak clearly and distinctly with no jargon and an ability to listen attentively is also required.

Slide

Use the appropriate telephone communication skills

- Assistance offered in a friendly manner
- Questions asked politely to establish the purpose of the call



Slide 17

Slide No	Trainer Notes
17.	• Telephone communication requires certain skills including the appropriate attitude, energy level, voice tone and volume • The ability to speak clearly and distinctly with no jargon and an ability to listen attentively is also required.

Use appropriate telephone techniques.

Telephone techniques must display professionalism and provide excellent service:

- Clarify caller requirements
- Repeat names, dates and times
- Check spelling



Slide 18

Slide No	Trainer Notes
18.	Efficient and effective use of the telephone requires skill in use and knowledge of the telephone system and the procedures and policies. All staff that use the telephone need to use appropriate telephone techniques. Well-developed telephone techniques will display an impression of professionalism and provide excellent service. Clarify caller requirements Use your questioning and listening skills to clarify what the caller has requested. Repeat names, dates and times Whenever guests give you details like their name make sure you spell it correctly. If you are not sure about the spelling then ask the guest to spell it. Read the letters back to the guest for clarification. Using the phonetic alphabet will help with an misunderstanding of letters being heard over the phone.

Slide

Class activity

- Check the pronunciation of the following names
- Use the Phonetic alphabet to clarify:
 - Tony Tan Keng Yam
 - Liu Shaoqi
 - Zakir Hussain
 - Sao Shwe Thaik
 - Surawit Khonsomboon
 - Salvador Laurel
 - Lim Goh Tong
 - Halim Saad



Slide 19

Slide No

Trainer Notes

19.

Clarify caller requirements

The trainee/students do the conversation in pairs and the student who will be the operator needs to rewrite the guest's name.

Slide

Describe acceptable telephone etiquette

Acceptable telephone technique includes:

- Answer the call within three rings
- Speak clearly and slowly
- Be courteous, civil and respectful
- Use appropriate opening phrase

(Continued)



Slide 20

Slide No	Trainer Notes
20.	Telephone Etiquette • Answer the call within three rings • Always speak clearly and slowly with courtesy, civility and respect • Avoid extreme volumes • Avoid jargon or hotel terminology • Speak with a smile on your face • Use an appropriate opening phrase and listen to the response. Reduction of background noise can make hearing more efficient.

Describe acceptable telephone etiquette

- Listen to caller
 - Reduce background noise
 - If there is caller ID on the telephone system, use guest's name
 - Repeat details back to the guest
- (Continued)



Slide 21

Slide No	Trainer Notes
21.	Trainer continues to discuss telephone etiquette with trainees inviting comments and stories from personal experience.

Slide

Describe acceptable telephone etiquette

- Verify spelling where required
- Transfer calls promptly
- Ask before putting guest on hold.
- Never eat, drink or smoke while on the phone
- Use suitable closing phrase – thank caller for calling



Slide 22

Slide No	Trainer Notes
22.	Trainer continues to discuss telephone etiquette with trainees inviting comments and stories from personal experience.

Slide

Class activity

- Role play to demonstrate telephone techniques
- Ring a friend and take a message
- Leave a message for a guest at the hotel who is:
 - Your boss
 - A couple on their anniversary
 - A friend in town to visit
 - A business associate here for a meeting



Slide 23

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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23.	Role play can happen in pairs and later be shared with a larger group.
-----	--

Slide

Identify common caller complaints about telephoning a business

Common caller complaints:

- Telephone rings too long before being answered
- Being placed on hold for too long
- Inability to get through – line is always busy
- Receptionist is defensive or abusive when guest complains

(continued)



Slide 24

Slide No

Trainer Notes

24.

Common caller complaints

- The telephone rings too long before being answered. If the guest is waiting to have a call answered they can become frustrated and angry. Some telephones have capacity to record how long a phone rings before it's attended to. A guest speaking face to face with staff will find it distracting if a phone rings and rings without being answered
- Being placed on hold for too long, Guests should always be asked if they want to be on hold or for a message to be taken. If a guest is on hold then staff should check back frequently
- Inability to get through, such as the line or number is always busy. Again if the guest is waiting to have a call answered they can become frustrated and angry. Some venues have electronic messaging or voicemail to avoid this
- If a guest has complained and the receptionist becomes defensive or abusive. The guest or caller may ask for the receptionist's name so the guest can take their complaint further.

Slide

Identify common caller complaints about telephoning a business

- Reception fails to determine where call should be directed
- Failure to listen properly to requests and questions
- System failure or staff incompetence with the system
- Lack of professionalism
- Lack of product/venue knowledge.



Slide 25

Slide No	Trainer Notes
25.	• Difficulty can arise if reception or the switchboard fails to determine where the call should be directed. This could mean there has been a failure to update contact information • One of the important points of communication is to listen. Failure to listen to guests' requests and questions can lead to misunderstanding and disgruntled guests • All systems can experience system failure. Often the failure is outside the control of management. Occasionally incompetence with the system; for example, the caller is disconnected when being transferred is the cause of guest dissatisfaction • Lack of professionalism, including failure to place call on hold before talking to colleagues, giving an inappropriate greeting, lack of knowledge about the establishment and its staff and the use of an improper tone of voice by receptionist are all situations which can be cause for caller complaint.

Slide

Class activity

Role play the following:

- Guest has rung to complain about a dirty bathroom
- Guest has rung to complain about a rude housemaid
- Guest has rung to say they will arrive late and been on hold for 20 minutes

(Continued)



Slide 26

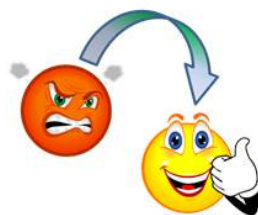
Slide No	Trainer Notes
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26.	This activity should be done in pairs.
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Slide

Class activity

- Guest has rung to ask help for reserving a taxi
- Guest has rung to ask help for reserving a flight ticket.



Slide 27

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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27.	This activity should be done in pairs.
-----	--

Slide

3. Receive incoming calls



Slide 28

Slide No	Trainer Notes
----------	---------------

28.	Trainer to discuss content of this Element with trainees.
-----	---

Slide

Prepare to receive incoming calls

- Start with a smile on your face
- Have paper and pen ready to record information
- Have a comprehensive list of in-house extensions
- Have a list of frequently called numbers



Slide 29

Slide No	Trainer Notes
29.	Reception or telephone staff should be doing all the necessary things in order to efficiently and confidently receive and make telephone calls: • Smile – this will reflect in your voice when you are talking, improving the tone and pitch • Paper and pen ready to record information • A list of in-house extensions by the phone, this may be electronic or written, or may be the in-house guest report as produced by the night audit • Have a list of frequently called numbers such as taxis, theatres, restaurants, tourist tour operators or other external services. There should also be a list of emergency numbers. When operating the telephone system staff must ensure there are no outside distractions.

Slide

Prepare to receive incoming calls

- Develop good knowledge of all departments and their areas of responsibility
- Sit upright and adjust the chair and equipment
- Prioritize calls according to property guidelines
- Activate call waiting and other automatic systems
- Ensure no outside distractions.



Slide 30

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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30.

Reception or telephone staff should be doing all the necessary things in order to efficiently and confidently receive and make telephone calls:

- smile – this will reflect in your voice when you are talking, improving the tone and pitch
- paper and pen ready to record information
- a list of in-house extensions by the phone, this may be electronic or written, or may be the in-house guest report as produced by the night audit
- have a list of frequently called numbers such as taxis, theatres, restaurants, tourist tour operators or other external services. There should also be a list of emergency numbers
- know where and how to direct each enquiry. A good knowledge of all departments and their areas of responsibility will ensure prompt response to all enquiries
- sit upright and adjust the chair and equipment to best suit the person's stature
- knowledge of all operator connected calls, and directory assistance procedures
- prioritize calls according to property guidelines

- activate call waiting and other automatic systems.
 - message waiting system
 - the wakeup call system
 - activate the voice mail system.

When operating the telephone system staff must ensure there are no outside distractions.

Slide

Example of arrival list



The William Angliss Hotel, School

03-05-11

12:24

Arrivals: Detailed

Room No.	Name	Company Travel Agent Source	Arr. Date	Dep. Date	Room Type	Adl.	Chl.	Rms.	Mit. Code	Src. Code	Res. Status	Rate Code	Currency	Rate Pay Amount/Mth.	Deposit Received
	Confirmation No.	VIP Last Room #	Block Code	ETA	Car. Code	Trans. Type	CH	Prev. Stays	Packages				Credit Card No.	Exp. Date	
Arrival Date 03-05-11															
	Abbott, Elizabeth, Mrs			03-05-11	05-05-11	LTS	2	0	1	FIT	IND	GCC	RACK	AUD	400.00 VC
150151	RG	204		14:00				14							XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX1111
	Res. Comments	General	POA VC												XX/XX
	Special Requests	COT													
	Color	GREEN													
	Browne, John, Mr			03-05-11	05-05-11	LTS	2	0	1	FIT	IND	GCC	RACK	AUD	400.00 VC
150650	NG			14:00				0							XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX1111
	Res. Comments	General	POA VC												XX/XX
	Special Requests	COT													
	Color	CYAN													
	Campbell, Henry, Mr			03-05-11	05-05-11	EXR	2	0	1	FIT	IND	GCC	RACK	AUD	375.00 VC
150400		501		14:00				4							XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX1111
	Res. Comments	General	POA VC												XX/XX
	Dalton, Sarah, Ms			03-05-11	05-05-11	CLR	2	0	1	FIT	IND	GCC	RACK	AUD	350.00 MC
150401				14:00				0							XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX4067
	Res. Comments	General	POA MC												XX/XX
	Eason, Cassandra, Ms			03-05-11	05-05-11	LTS	2	0	1	FIT	IND	GCC	RACK	AUD	400.00 VC
150651	RG			14:00				0							XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX1111
	Res. Comments	General	POA VC												XX/XX
	Special Requests	COT													
	Color	GREEN													
	Fairsworth, Cynthia			03-05-11	05-05-11	EXR	2	0	1	FIT	IND	GCC	RACK	AUD	375.00 VC
150655	RG	308		14:00				4							XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX1111
	Res. Comments	General	POA VC												XX/XX
	Color	GREEN													

Slide 31

Slide No Trainer Notes

31.

Discuss the above example of an arrivals list – Opera Software.

Slide

Answer calls promptly in accordance with house standards

- Use house standard greetings
- Identify self and the hotel or resort
- Greet the caller and offer assistance or question them to ascertain the purpose of the incoming call
- Focus on the call, especially listening carefully to the caller's voice



Slide 32

Slide No	Trainer Notes
32.	All staff who use the telephone to accept incoming calls should maintain the same standard etiquette and skills. When answering call staff should ensure all calls: • Are answered before house ring limit is reached, usually by the third ring • Use an enterprise standard greeting is a statement of who you are and what your establishment's values are • Identifying self or position and the hotel or resort, greet the caller and offer assistance or question them to ascertain the purpose of the incoming call • Focusing and concentrating on the call, especially listening carefully to the callers voice.

Slide

Answer calls promptly in accordance with house standards

- Take notes and details of any request
- Identify whether caller is calling long-distance or international
- Identify if caller is a designated VIP caller, return guest or corporate guest whose company has a contract with the venue



Slide 33

Slide No	Trainer Notes
33.	All staff who use the telephone to accept incoming calls should maintain the same standard etiquette and skills. When answering call staff should ensure all calls: • Are answered before house ring limit is reached, usually by the third ring • Use an enterprise standard greeting is a statement of who you are and what your establishment's values are • Identifying self or position and the hotel or resort, greet the caller and offer assistance or question them to ascertain the purpose of the incoming call • Focusing and concentrating on the call, especially listening carefully to the callers voice • Taking notes and details of any request • Identifying whether caller is calling long-distance or internationally • Identifying if caller is a designated VIP caller, a return guest or a corporate guest whose company has a contract with the hotel or resort.

Slide

Identify long-distance or international calls

- Calls from other countries will need to be co-ordinated with time zone information
- The list of country codes should be placed in an easy place and accessible to all of the staff
- Charges for international calls vary according to time zone and distance



Slide 34

Slide No	Trainer Notes
34.	Calls from other countries will need to be co-ordinated with time zone information. Charges for international calls vary according to time zone and distance.

Slide

Identify long-distance or international calls

- When answering incoming calls from international locations, staff may need to have language skills or access to interpreters
- International calls may be connected by a telephone operator or satellite connection



Slide 35

Slide No	Trainer Notes
35.	When answering incoming calls from international locations, you need language skills or access to interpreters or software that would perform translation. International connected by a telephone operator or satellite connection; fees will vary according to the country and duration of the call. A satellite call is more expensive than wireless connection.

Slide

Establish the purpose of incoming calls

- Determine the purpose of the call
- Follow up an initial greeting with clarifying questions
- Use the hotel's database to find information
- Use selling and promotional techniques



Slide 36

Slide No	Trainer Notes
36.	• When receiving incoming calls it's important to determine the purpose of the call so it can directed to the appropriate staff or department In a large hotel or resort • The telephone operator may answer calls on behalf of several different departments and then transmit the information to appropriate staff by pager or text.

Slide

Respond to caller requests, where appropriate

- Give the guest your full attention
- Show genuine interest in their questions
- If you know the answer:
 - Tell the guest and ask if there is anything else you can help them with
 - Finish the conversation with a pleasant greeting

(continued)



Slide 37

Slide No	Trainer Notes
37.	Respond to guest requests: • React promptly, give the guest your full attention and show genuine interest in their questions. If you know the answer: • Tell the guest and ask if there is anything else you can help them with • Finish the conversation with a pleasant greeting, e.g. 'I hope you enjoy your stay'.

Slide

Respond to caller requests, where appropriate

If you don't know the answer:

- Never say 'No', apologise where an immediate, correct response cannot be given
- Offer to find out and get back to the guest with the answer

(Continued)



Slide 38

Slide No

Trainer Notes

38.

If you don't know the answer:

- Never make it up or say, 'I don't know' or 'That's not my department'. You should apologise where an immediate, correct response cannot be given.
- Offer to find out and get back to the guest with the answer. This may involve putting the guest on hold or taking details and returning the call.

Slide

Respond to caller requests, where appropriate

- The guest should not be kept waiting while you find the answer
- Offer to deliver the information or call back
- Make sure you follow up and get back to the guest quickly



Slide 39

Slide No	Trainer Notes
39.	• Do not keep the guest waiting while you try to find the answer. Offer to deliver the information or call back or transfer the call to a guest services attendant or another department who can best answer the question • Make sure you follow up and get back to the guest quickly.

Slide

Take messages from callers

To take messages accurately make sure that you record:

- Who the message is for
- Who left the message
- Repeat the name back and check if it's correct

(Continued)



Slide 40

Slide No

Trainer Notes

40.

To take messages accurately make sure that you record:

- Who the message is for asking for the full name and remembering that you might have 10 guests with the name Ng or Lee staying in the hotel
- Who left the message; repeat the name back and make sure that you have the correct spelling. Record any details of Company and the caller's city, which is required to estimate time for the return call to occur
- The number and any extension of the person leaving the message. Check and repeat this back to the caller so that you do not give your guest the wrong number.

Slide

Take messages from callers

- Record the number of the person leaving the message
- Take an accurate message
- Confirm the importance and urgency and any action requested or promised

(Continued)



Slide 41

Slide No	Trainer Notes
41.	• The number and any extension of the person leaving the message. Check and repeat this back to the caller so that you do not give your guest the wrong number • An accurate message should be taken; repeat the message back to confirm this with the caller. Confirm the importance and urgency and any action requested or promised.

Slide

Take messages from callers

- Lastly record the date and time of the call, including the action and follow-up
- Include the name of the person who recorded the message



Slide 42

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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42.

Lastly record the date and time of the call, including the action and follow-up .Also include the name of the person who recorded the message. If the message has been entered into an electronic system or PMS, then it will automatically be dated, time stamped and carry the ID of the staff member who entered the data.

Slide

Class activity

- Use a message pad
- Role play taking guests' requests and messages
- Work with a partner where one plays a guest and the other the telephone operator



Slide 43

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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43.	This helps the students become familiar with the art of message taking.
-----	---

Slide

Relay messages and follow-up as necessary

- Messages can be left under guests' doors
- A message notification can be activated
- Text messages can be transmitted instantly

(Continued)



Slide 44

Slide No

Trainer Notes

44.

- All messages received and recorded need to be distributed to their recipients
- In regards to distribution of messages it is essential that it is timely and accurately distribute.

Slide

Relay messages and follow-up as necessary

- Messages may be left in a pigeon-hole or message book. A guest may call to collect a message
- Messages left for incoming guests may be delivered verbally or printed
- A message may carry a facility to confirm delivery



Slide 45

Slide No	Trainer Notes
45.	• Porter duties usually include taking messages, packages or mail for in-house guests in liaison with reception staff, receiving and distributing guest mail, messages, emails and faxes • A message may be left for an expected guest and notification can be attached electronically to the reservation information.

Slide

Facilitate conference calls

A conference call:

- Is a call where more than one party can listen in
- may be designed to allow the called party to participate during the call
- May be set up so the called party only listens and cannot speak
- Can be set up to view the other caller



Slide 46

Slide No

Trainer Notes

46.

A conference call is a telephone call in which the calling party wishes to have more than one called party listen in to the audio portion of the call. The conference calls may be designed to allow the called party to participate during the call, or the call may be set up so that the called party merely listens into the call and cannot speak. It can also be set up to view the other caller. This is sometimes called Teleconference.

Slide

Deal with suspicious or threatening callers

- It is important to remain calm:
 - Do not hang up
 - Get detailed information
 - Do not laugh or treat the threat lightly
 - Don't be angry or upset
 - Confirm the call is genuine
 - Keep a record of the conversation

(continued)



Slide 47

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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47.	Whatever the threat or suspicious behaviour there are certain steps to follow. It is important to remain calm. Do not hang up as this can enable the authorities to trace the call. By capturing as much detail as possible about the call, caller and nature of the threat, the caller should be treated with respect and not abused. Staff should not laugh or treat the threat lightly. It's important not to be angry or upset as this could cause the caller to become agitated and hang up or escalate the situation. But it is also important to confirm the call is genuine and not a prank or joke. Despite the cause or reason a record should be kept of the conversation.
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Slide

Deal with suspicious or threatening callers

- For a bomb threat:
 - Get as much information as possible
 - Find out if possible who is making the threat
 - Try to find out why/how they will carry out their threat
 - Find out who specifically the threat is against
 - Is there any action to be taken?

(continued)



Slide 48

Slide No	Trainer Notes
48.	If it's a bomb threat then try to get as much information as possible, who the group or individuals are who are making the threat, why and how they will carry out their threats. There is a need to establish who specifically the threat is against and why or when it will occur. Is there any action the telephonist can take that will solve the problem or difficulty?

Slide

Deal with suspicious or threatening callers

- Policies and procedures have to be followed
- Initiate an evacuation or implement the Emergency Management Plan (EMP)
- Notify relevant authorities
- Take it seriously
- Immediately contact a supervisor



Slide 49

Slide No	Trainer Notes
49.	The venue's policies and procedures have to be followed and management and other staff notified of the situation. It may be that staff need to initiate an evacuation or implement the Emergency Management Plan (EMP) and also notify relevant authorities. If there is a serious threat management will call departments and room numbers to facilitate the warning of people in accordance with the Emergency Management Plan. All threats and suspicious behaviour should be taken seriously and immediately contact a supervisor as to what is occurring.

Slide

Manage difficult callers

Staff may find themselves having to answer the phone to a difficult caller. This will require tact, quick action or initiative:

- Communication
- Intoxication
- Bad service
- Rude callers



Slide 50

Slide No	Trainer Notes
50.	When answering a difficult call the telephonist must first listen, then apologise. Come to a conclusion explaining what action can be taken. Identify how the complaint will be dealt with and always follow up. By capturing as much detail as possible about the caller the caller should still be treated with respect. But it is also important to confirm the call is genuine and not a prank or hoax. Despite the cause or reason a record should be kept of the conversation. A difficult guest may simply be misunderstood, but for those who are angry or upset and not responding positively, remember to be tactful, keep cool, sympathise and try to give assistance but always call or notify management.

Slide

Prepare voicemail messages and background music

- Voice mail is a computer-based system that will answer the caller and deliver voice information using an ordinary telephone
- Most telephone systems have the ability to play an advertising message or music when a call is on hold
- A guest on hold will wait if there is not silence at the end of the phone.



Slide 51

Slide No	Trainer Notes
51.	• Voice mail is a computer-based system that will answer the caller and deliver voice information about organisations, products and services, using an ordinary telephone. The term is also used more broadly to denote any system of conveying a stored voice messages • Voicemail systems are designed to convey a caller's recorded audio message to a recipient • Most telephone systems have the ability to play an advertising message or music when a call is placed on hold or before it answers • Calls are placed on hold because there is a bank up of calls and the operator is busy • Sometimes calls are put on hold manually. For instance, when you need to get some information for the guest you will inform them that they are going to be put on hold while you collect this information or speak to a supervisor. In this circumstance music or promotional messages can be used rather than the caller listening to nothing.

Slide

4. Redirect incoming calls



Slide 52

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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52.	Trainer to explain the idea and purpose of redirecting calls.
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Slide

Transfer calls as appropriate

The procedure to transfer a call is:

- Answer the incoming call according to venue procedures
- Establish who the call is for
- Thank the caller and ask the caller if you can transfer them

(Continued)

Slide 53

Slide No	Trainer Notes
53.	Discuss why a call needs to be put on hold The procedure to transfer a call is: • Answer the incoming call according to establishment procedures • Establish who the call is for • Thank the caller and ask the caller if you can transfer them.

Slide

Transfer calls as appropriate

- Explain where the call is being transferred to
- If the caller does not want to be transferred you need to take a message.



Slide 54

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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54.

Explain where they are being transferred to.
If the caller doesn't want to be transferred you need to take a message.

Slide

Place calls on hold as appropriate.

Placing a call on hold:

- Calls that need to be placed on hold usually have music or a recorded message to listen to
- Before placing a call on hold, ask the caller's permission
- Return to the call within 30 seconds and provide an update on the status of their call.



Slide 55

Slide No	Trainer Notes
55.	Discuss why a call needs to be put on hold • The extension may be busy • There are several other calls to attend to at the same time • If a caller indicates that they do not want to be put on hold and ask to have the call dealt with immediately, then you may have to take information and return the call at a later time • Most telephone systems have the ability to play an advertising message or music when a call is placed on hold or before it answers • Sometimes calls are put on hold manually. For instance, when you need to get some information for the guest you will inform them that they are going to be put on hold while you collect this information or speak to a supervisor. It is good practice to advise the guest what you are doing • If a caller is on hold don't forget to keep coming back to them to let them know what is happening. For instance, the line they are waiting for is still busy - do they want to call back or leave a message?

Recommended training equipment

- Equipment for incoming calls
- Computers with Front Office software ,currently Micros Fidelio opera Vs 5 [requires single dedicated server for Oracle]
- Hotel plan with restaurants, leisure centre, porter area, function area etc with operating times and room types with Market segments, various rates etc
- Internet access
- Printers with various papers and templates for messages
- Fax machine
- Hotel stationary
- Telephone one per each computer
- Whiteboard, simulated Hotel Front Desk with filing system and printer and computer access for 2 computers
- Visitor information selection
- Access to hotel room with telephone, intranet and messaging system.

Instructions for Trainers for using PowerPoint – Presenter View

Connect your laptop or computer to your projector equipment as per manufacturers' instructions.

In PowerPoint, on the **Slide Show** menu, click **Set Up Show**.

Under Multiple monitors, select the Show Presenter View check box.

In the **Display slide show** on list, click the monitor you want the slide show presentation to appear on.

Source: <http://office.microsoft.com>

Note:

In Presenter View:

You see your notes and have full control of the presentation

Your trainees only see the slide projected on to the screen

More Information

You can obtain more information on how to use PowerPoint from the Microsoft Online Help Centre, available at:

<http://office.microsoft.com/training/training.aspx?AssetID=RC011298761033>

Note Regarding Currency of URLs

Please note that where references have been made to URLs in these training resources trainers will need to verify that the resource or document referred to is still current on the internet. Trainers should endeavour, where possible, to source similar alternative examples of material where it is found that either the website or the document in question is no longer available online.

Appendix – ASEAN acronyms

AADCP	ASEAN – Australia Development Cooperation Program.
ACCSTP	ASEAN Common Competency Standards for Tourism Professionals.
AEC	ASEAN Economic Community.
AMS	ASEAN Member States.
ASEAN	Association of Southeast Asian Nations.
ASEC	ASEAN Secretariat.
ATM	ASEAN Tourism Ministers.
ATPMC	ASEAN Tourism Professionals Monitoring Committee.
ATPRS	ASEAN Tourism Professional Registration System.
ATFTMD	ASEAN Task Force on Tourism Manpower Development.
CATC	Common ASEAN Tourism Curriculum.
MRA	Mutual Recognition Arrangement.
MTCO	Mekong Tourism Coordinating office.
NTO	National Tourism Organisation.
NTPB	National Tourism Professional Board.
RQFSRS	Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System.
TPCB	Tourism Professional Certification Board.

